

Auto Document Issue Register
Updater User Guide

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**Software
Version 2.0**

This document provides a detailed operational and functional overview of the Auto Document Issue Register Updater software. The guide explains the purpose of the application, system workflow, user interface, field descriptions, automation logic, and operational procedures.

1. Software Interface

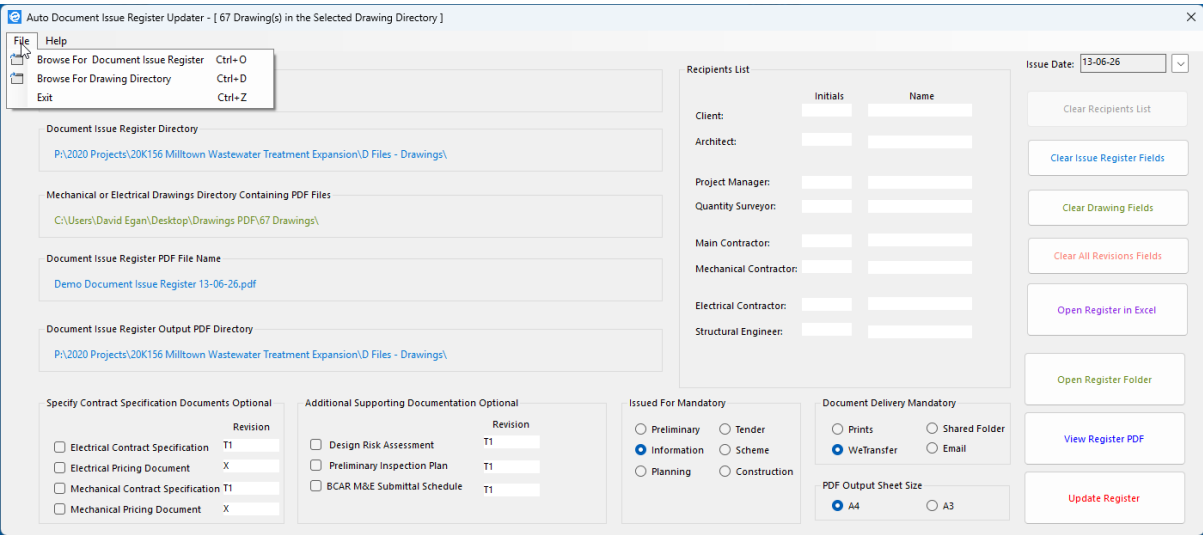


Figure 1

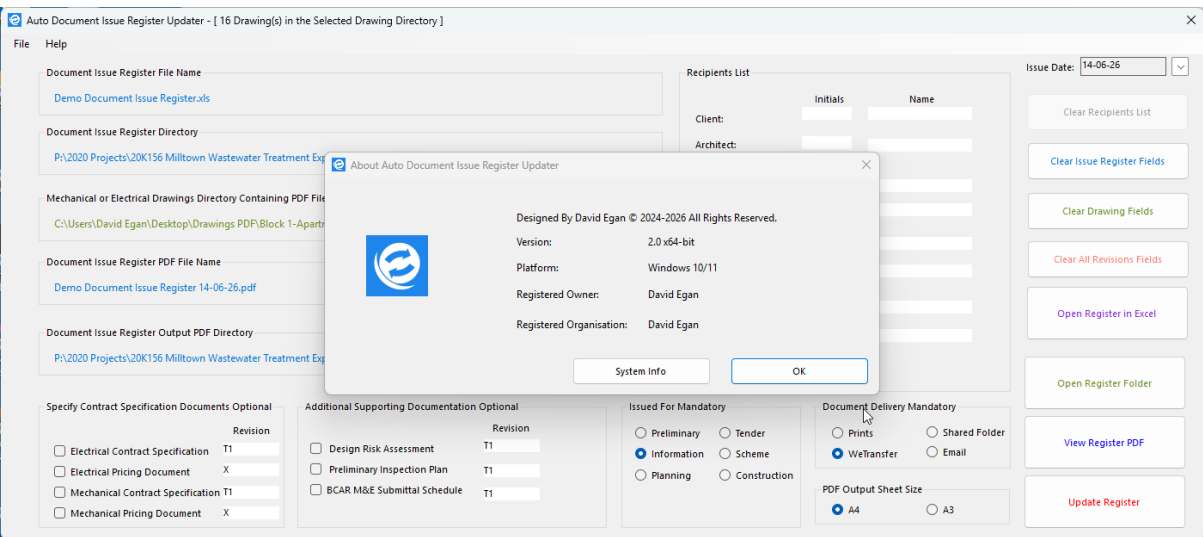


Figure 2

About Auto Document Issue Register Updater

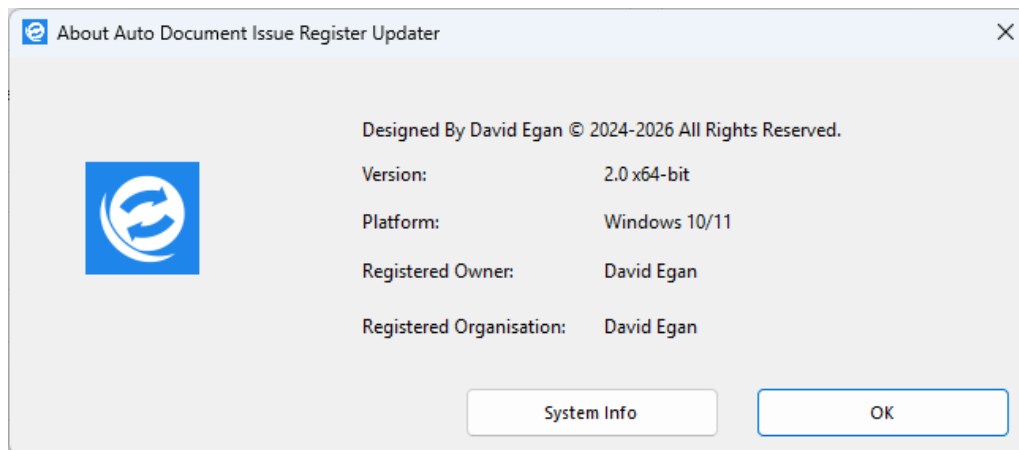


Figure 3

Description: Displays application version, platform, and registration details.

When to use: Access via Help > About Auto Document Issue Register Updater to verify version number before contacting support or checking for updates.

2. Functional Purpose of the Software

- Automates document issue register generation and updating.
- Scans drawing directories for PDF drawing files.
- Updates project distribution registers with revision and issue data.
- Creates standardised PDF issue registers for document distribution.

3. Functional Operation Workflow

Step 1 – Select the Document Issue Register

The user selects the existing Document Issue Register file using the 'Browse For Document Issue Register' function.

Step 2 – Select the Drawing Directory

The user selects the folder containing Mechanical or Electrical drawing PDFs. The software scans this directory and identifies all available PDF drawing files for inclusion within the issue register update process.

Step 3 – Read Drawing Information

The application processes the PDF file names and extracts drawing references, revision identifiers, and drawing metadata where applicable.

Step 4 – Configure Issue Information

The user enters issue metadata including:

- Issue date
- Recipient details
- Revision references
- Issue purpose
- Delivery method

Step 5 – Select Optional Supporting Documentation

Optional project documentation can be included within the register update. Each document type can contain its own revision reference.

Step 6 – Update Register

When the 'Update Register' button is pressed, the software:

- Validates entered information
- Reads the selected drawing directory
- Updates the register data structure
- Generates or updates the PDF register output
- Saves the updated register to the specified output directory

Step 7 – Output and Review

The user can:

- Open the register in Excel
 - Open the output folder
 - View the generated PDF register
- for verification and project issue distribution.

4. User Interface Description

File Menu

Provides access to core file selection and application exit functions.

Document Issue Register Directory

Displays the selected project register file location.

Drawing Directory Field

Displays the selected directory containing project drawing PDFs.

PDF File Name Field

Displays the automatically generated issue register PDF filename.

Output PDF Directory

Displays the destination folder where generated PDF registers are saved.

Recipients List

Enter recipient initials and names for document issue distribution records.

Optional Documentation Panels

Allows inclusion of supporting specification and compliance documents.

Issue Type Controls

Defines the purpose of the document issue.

Document Delivery Controls

Defines how documents are distributed to recipients.

PDF Sheet Size Controls

Defines the sheet size PDF's are generated at.

Action Buttons

Provides operational commands including clearing fields, opening files, viewing outputs, and updating the register.

5. Detailed Functional Controls

- Browse For Document Issue Register: Opens a file browser allowing the user to select the primary project issue register.
- Browse For Drawing Directory: Opens a folder browser allowing selection of the drawing PDF directory.
- Clear Recipients List: Removes all entered recipient names and initials.
- Clear Issue Register Fields: Resets issue register related information.
- Clear Drawing Fields: Clears the selected drawing directory information.
- Clear All Revisions Fields: Removes all revision entries from optional documentation fields.
- Open Register in Excel: Launches the associated Excel register file for editing or review.
- Open Register Folder: Opens the folder containing the register outputs.
- View Register PDF: Launches the generated PDF issue register.
- Update Register: Executes the complete register updating and PDF generation operation.

6. Recipients List Functionality

The Recipients List section enables controlled distribution management. Each project stakeholder can be assigned initials and a descriptive name. This information is used during issue register generation and distribution tracking.

- Client
- Architect
- Project Manager
- Quantity Surveyor
- Main Contractor
- Mechanical Contractor
- Electrical Contractor
- Structural Engineer

7. Revision Management Logic

Revision fields allow the user to define the revision status of each optional document. Typical revision codes include:

- T1 – Tender Revision
- P1 – Preliminary Revision
- C1 – Construction Revision
- X – Not Included / Not Issued

These revision references are incorporated into the generated issue register.

8. Issue Type Operation

The Issue Type section determines the operational purpose of the document issue. Only one issue type should normally be selected for each distribution.

- Preliminary
- Information
- Planning
- Tender
- Scheme
- Construction

9. Document Delivery Operation

The delivery selection defines how documents are distributed to project stakeholders.

- Prints
- WeTransfer
- Shared Folder
- Email

10. PDF Output Sheet Size

The output sheet size determines whether PDF file is in A4 or A3 format.

- A4
- A3

11. Internal Functional Logic

- Reads project drawing PDFs from the selected directory.
- Associates issue metadata with document records.
- Builds an updated issue register structure.
- Applies revision and issue classifications.
- Generates updated PDF register outputs.
- Maintains standardised issue formatting.

12. Recommended Operating Procedure

- Verify all PDF drawing names before processing.
- Ensure revision references are correct.
- Maintain consistent project directory structures.
- Store generated registers within controlled project folders.
- Review generated PDF outputs before distribution.

13. Troubleshooting

Problem: Register does not update

Solution: Verify the selected register and drawing directory paths.

Problem: PDF output missing

Solution: Ensure the output directory is accessible and writable.

Problem: Excel register does not open

Solution: Verify Microsoft Excel is installed and the register file exists.

Problem: Drawings not detected

Solution: Confirm the selected directory contains PDF files.

14. Conclusion

The Auto Document Issue Register Updater provides a structured and automated method for managing project drawing distributions, revision control, and issue register generation. The software improves consistency, reduces manual administration effort, and supports controlled project documentation workflows

15. Application Error Messages

15.1 Invalid Document Issue Register File



Figure 4

Error Message: "The selected file is not a valid document issue register Excel file."

Cause: The selected .xlsx or .xls file does not match the required Document Issue Register template structure.

Resolution:

1. Verify you selected the correct Excel file.
2. Ensure the file contains the standard Document Issue Register sheets and column headers.
3. Do not select PDFs, Word docs, or other file types.
4. If using a custom template, confirm it matches the application specifications.

15.2 Successful Update Confirmation

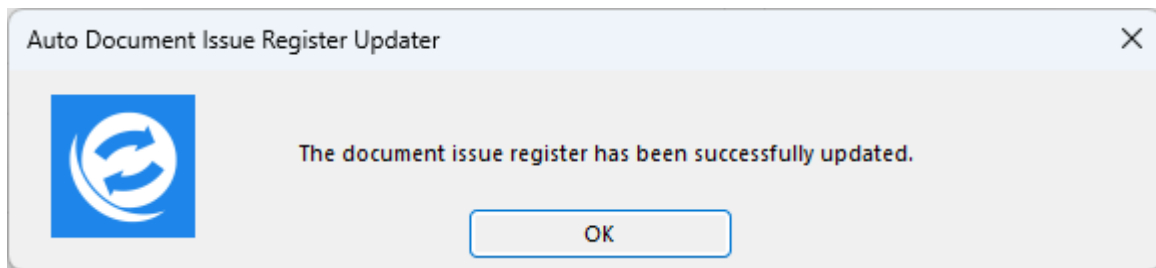


Figure 5

Message: "The document issue register has been successfully updated."

Meaning: All drawing revisions have been processed. Both the Excel register and PDF register have been updated.

Action: No action required. You can now open the updated Excel or PDF register to review changes.

15.3 Non-Compliant PDF Drawing Files

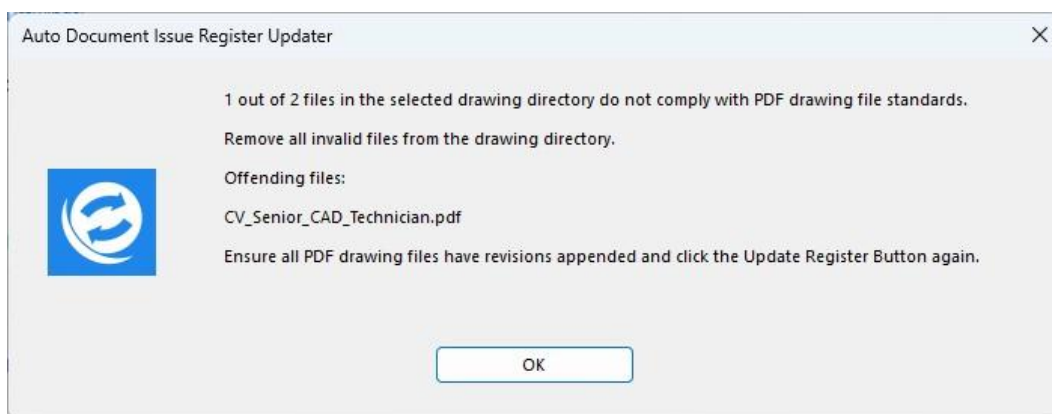


Figure 6

Error Message: "1 out of 2 files in the selected drawing directory do not comply with PDF drawing file standards."

Cause: The directory contains files that are not valid PDF drawings, or drawings without proper revision naming.

Example Offending File: CV_Senior_CAD_Technician.pdf - this is a CV, not a drawing.

Resolution:

1. Remove all non-drawing files from the directory.
2. Rename all PDF drawings to include drawing number and revision. See Appendix A 16.1 Drawing File Naming Requirements.

3. Ensure only current issue drawings remain in the folder.
4. Click "Update Register" again.

15.4 Multiple Instances Running

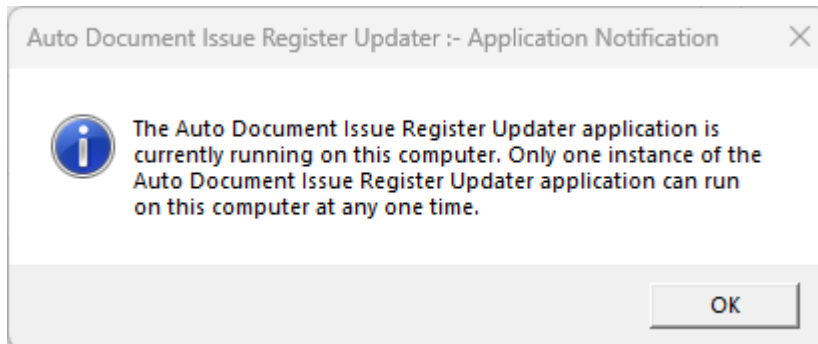


Figure 7

Error Message: "The auto document issue register updater application is currently running on this computer. Only one instance can run at any one time."

Cause: You launched the application while another instance is already open.

Resolution:

1. Check your Windows taskbar for the existing application window.
2. If not visible, open Task Manager (Ctrl+Shift+Esc) and end "AutoRegisterUpdater" task.
3. **Relaunch** the application.

15.5 PDF Register Does Not Exist



Figure 8

Error Message: "The document issue register PDF file does not exist yet. Click the Update Register Button to create it, and try viewing it again."

Cause: You attempted to open/view the PDF register before it has been generated.

Resolution:

1. Ensure you have selected both the Excel register and drawing directory.
2. Click "Update Register" to process the files and generate the PDF.
3. After successful update, the PDF will be available to view.

15.6 Selected Excel File Missing

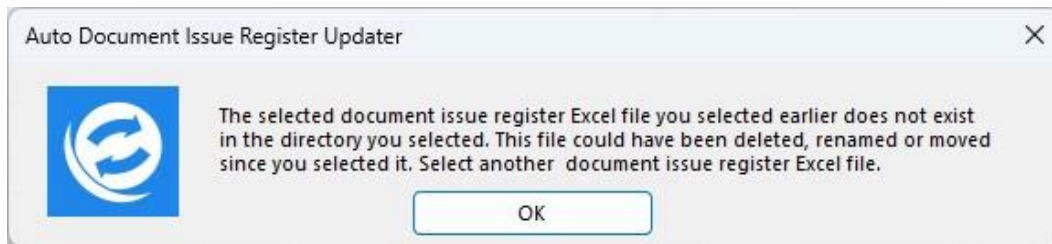


Figure 9

Error Message: "The selected document issue register Excel file you selected earlier does not exist in the directory you selected. This file could have been deleted, renamed or moved since you selected it."

Cause: The file path stored by the application is no longer valid. The Excel file was moved, renamed, or deleted.

Resolution:

1. Click "Browse" to re-select the Document Issue Register Excel file.
2. Navigate to the current location of the file.
3. Avoid moving or renaming the register while the application is open.

15.7 Select Document Issue Register Prompt

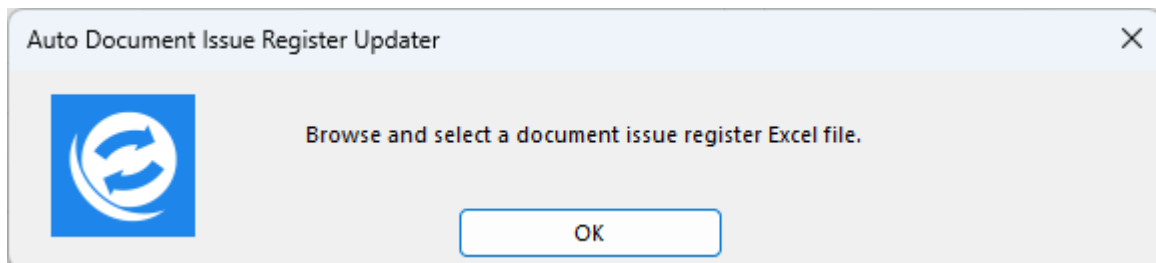


Figure 10

Message: "Browse and select a document issue register Excel file."

Description: Standard prompt displayed when no Excel register has been selected yet.

Action: Use the file browser to locate and select your main Document Issue Register .xlsx or .xls file. This is typically named something like "ProjectName_Document_Issue_Register.xlsx" or "ProjectName_Document_Issue_Register.xls".

15.8 Select Drawing Directory Prompt



Figure 11

Message: "Browse and select an Electrical or Mechanical drawing directory containing PDF drawing files."

Description: Prompt to select the folder containing all current issue PDF drawings.

Action:

1. Browse to the folder containing your latest PDF drawings.
2. Ensure the folder contains ONLY valid drawing PDFs with revision numbers.
3. Do not include superseded drawings, CVs, or other documents.

15.9 File In Use By Another Program

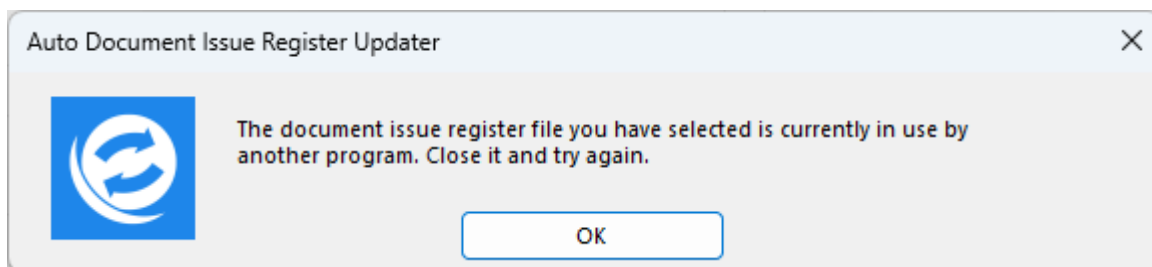


Figure 12

Error Message: "The document issue register file you have selected is currently in use by another program. Close it and try again."

Cause: The Excel Document Issue Register file is currently open in Microsoft Excel, Teams, or another application.

Resolution:

1. Close Microsoft Excel completely - check for any hidden windows.
2. If the file is on OneDrive/SharePoint, ensure it is not being edited by another user.
3. Wait 10 seconds for file locks to release.
4. Click "Update Register" again.

15.10 No PDF Drawing Files Found



Figure 13

Error: "The drawings directory you selected does not contain any PDF drawing files. Select another drawing directory."

15.11 Drawing Directory Does Not Exist

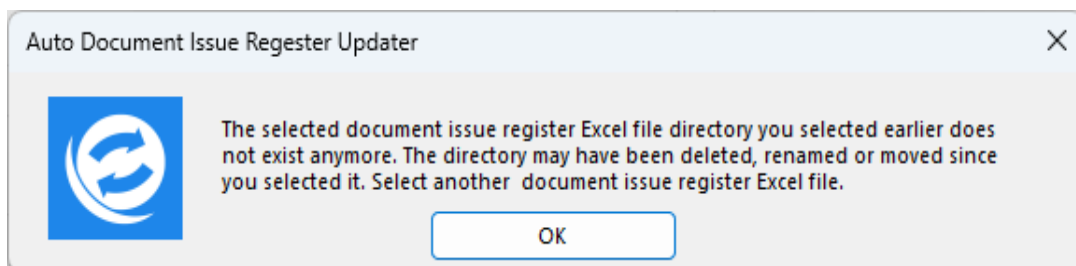


Figure 14

Error: "The drawing directory you selected earlier does not exist anymore. The directory may have been deleted, renamed or moved since you selected it."

Cause: The file path stored by the application is no longer valid. The directory was moved, renamed, or deleted.

Resolution:

1. Click "Browse" to re-select the Document Issue Register Excel file.
2. Navigate to the current location of the file.
3. Avoid moving or renaming the directory while the application is open.

15.12 MSINFO32 Utility Not Found

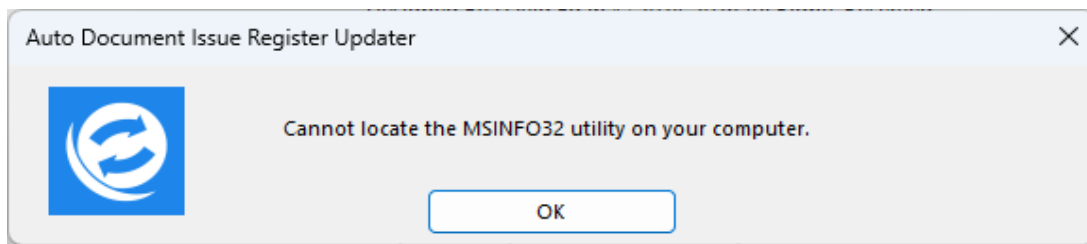


Figure 15

Error: "Cannot locate the MSINFO32 utility on your computer."

Action:

1. The MSINFO32 utility displays the Microsoft System Information application on your computer. This utility is standard on all Windows Operating Systems. It displays the hardware details of your computer. The msinfo32.exe utility resides in this directory on your computer C:\Windows\System32

15.13 Microsoft Excel Not Installed

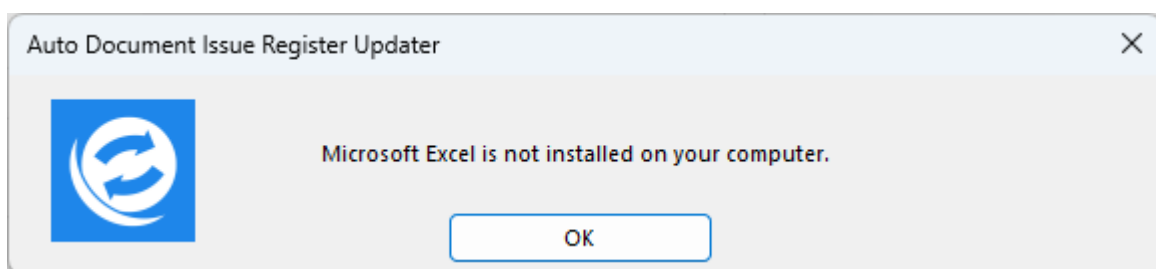


Figure 16

Error: "Microsoft Excel is not installed on your computer."

Action:

1. Ensure Microsoft 365 which includes Excel is installed on your computer. The Auto Document Issue Register Updater software requires Excel and won't operate without it.

15.14 General Troubleshooting Tips

- Always close the Document Issue Register Excel file in all programs before running an update.
- Maintain consistent file naming: [DrawingNumber]_[Discipline]_[Sheet]_[RevX].pdf - Example: E-101 3 BED BUNGALOW ELECTRICAL SERVICES LAYOUT-A3-P2.pdf
- Keep only current issue drawings in your selected directory. Archive superseded revisions elsewhere.
- Do not rename, move, or delete the Excel register while the application is running.
- If an update fails, check the drawing directory for non-compliant files first.
- For persistent issues, note the exact error message and check Help > About for your version number before contacting support.
- Back up your Document Issue Register Excel file before major updates.

16. Appendix A

16.1 Drawing File Naming Requirements

Drawing files must follow the naming convention shown in the examples below:

E-100-J1 ELECTRICAL SERVICES LAYOUT HOUSE TYPE J1-A0-C1.pdf

M-300-1 BLOCK 1 GROUND FLOOR WATER SERVICES LAYOUT-A2-C1.pdf

M-200 BLOCK 1 GROUND FLOOR VENTILATION SERVICES LAYOUT-A2-C1.pdf

To be accepted by the software, all drawing filenames must strictly adhere to this format, including the required spacing and delimiters.

The filename structure consists of:

[Drawing Number] [Drawing Description]-[Sheet Size]-[Revision].pdf

Where:

- **Drawing Number** and **Drawing Description** are separated by a single space.
- The **Drawing Description** is followed by a hyphen (-) and the **Sheet Size**.
- The **Sheet Size** is followed by a hyphen (-) and the **Revision**.
- The filename must end with the .pdf file extension.

It is important that the spacing and delimiter placement are maintained exactly as shown in the examples. Any deviation from the required naming convention, including missing spaces, misplaced hyphens, will result in the software rejecting the file and displaying an error message. Refer to section 15.3 in this guide.

Only drawings saved in **PDF format** (.pdf) can be processed by the software.

16.2 Document Issue Register Excel file formats .xls or .xlsx

This software supports both .xls and .xlsx file formats. The .xls format is a legacy Microsoft Excel format that remains fully supported for compatibility purposes. The .xlsx format is the modern Excel standard and is also fully supported.

16.3 Graphics in your Excel Document Issue Register

This software preserves the graphical integrity of logos imported into your Excel register. Logo images retain their original appearance, including their size, position, and visual quality, ensuring consistency between the source Excel workbook and the software display. The same high-quality graphics are maintained in generated PDF reports, with logo fidelity preserved across both A4 and A3 page formats.

16.4 Dialog Location on Screen Saved on Exit

The application now remembers the dialog's screen position and restores it the next time it is opened.

16.5 Software Limitation – Initial Pass Only

This software is designed to complete only the initial pass of the register. The subsequent addition of drawings to the register must be carried out manually. The initial population of the register represents the most significant portion of the work, as it involves entering all drawings for the first time. Any additional drawings added later, as well as all subsequent revisions, must also be completed manually.

16.6 Software Design Philosophy

There is no AI in this application.

It has been built with reinforced concrete and steel—the way dependable software was built 20 years ago.

I haven't lost my way. I still believe that good software should have strong foundations. It should be predictable, dependable, and engineered to do its job every single day.

My focus has never been on following trends. It has always been on solving real problems with practical software that users can trust.

Like the structures designed by engineers, software should be built to last. It should do exactly what it was designed to do, consistently and reliably.

That philosophy has guided me throughout my career, and it continues to guide every application I build today.

I continue to build software you can rely on, day after day.

I am happy to share.

David Egan
Software Developer & Systems Architect

